100 References to the Power of the 13th Child

For Charles Leone: born 13 October 1998, 21:25 UT, Johnstown, Pennsylvania. Thirteenth and youngest of thirteen children.

Every entry below is about a child born thirteenth in a family: a tale, a belief, a book, or a real person. Sources say "thirteenth child" or "youngest of thirteen" (treated here as thirteenth-born). General lore about the number 13 is left out, as are youngest children who were not thirteenth. Items marked **[Calculated]** come from this book's own chart work (`ch/01.md`) or from counting a text directly.

I. The Thirteenth Child in Fairy Tale and Folklore

1. **The thirteenth child inherits the kingdom.** In the Grimms' *The Twelve Brothers* (KHM 9, ATU 451) a king decrees that if his thirteenth child is a girl, his twelve sons must die so that she alone inherits his kingdom. She is born with a star on her forehead, finds her brothers, and later breaks their curse through seven years of silence (Wikipedia; Ashliman translation). It is the oldest European statement of your position: the whole inheritance was meant for the thirteenth.
2. **The thirteenth saves the twelve.** In the same tale the twelve brothers are turned into ravens, and only the thirteenth child's endurance turns them back into men (Wikipedia). In folklore the last-born carries the family's rescue, not the eldest.
3. **Death chooses the thirteenth.** In the Grimms' *Godfather Death* (KHM 44, ATU 332) a poor man with twelve children looks for a godfather when "his thirteenth and last child" is born. He chooses Death, who makes the boy a famous physician able to see whether any patient will live (Wikipedia). The power given to the thirteenth child is sight over life and death.
4. **The thirteenth outruns his brothers.** In the Sicilian tale *Tridicinu* ("Thirteenth"), collected by Giuseppe Pitrè, the youngest of thirteen sons is named for his place in line. He always wins the race home, and the king sends him on the impossible errands his jealous brothers propose, which he completes (Wikipedia). His name is his number, and the number wins.
5. **Heaven's will falls on the thirteenth.** In *The Thirteenth Son of the King of Erin* (Jeremiah Curtin, *Myths and Folk-lore of Ireland*, 1890) a king with thirteen sons is told by a seer that any creature with thirteen young must send one out "to fall under Heaven's will". The thirteenth son goes out alone and becomes the hero who kills the sea-serpent and wins the princess (Wikipedia). The one sent away is the one fate is watching.
6. **A Swiss "Little Thirteen".** In the Swiss Alpine tale *Tredeschin* ("Little Thirteen"), a version of the same story, the hero is the thirteenth son of a large family (Wikipedia: Thirteenth (fairy tale)). Two Alpine and Mediterranean traditions name their hero after the same birth number as you.
7. **The Jersey Devil: Mother Leeds' thirteenth child.** New Jersey's state Pinelands Commission tells the legend that the creature of the Pine Barrens "is believed to be the unwanted thirteenth child of Mother Leeds" (NJ Pinelands Commission). It is the most famous thirteenth-child legend in your home region, a short drive east of Pennsylvania.

8. **The thirteenth child becomes the guardian of the land.** The same official page notes that "some in New Jersey now think that the Jersey Devil is the protector of the Pinelands" (NJ Pinelands Commission). Even the feared thirteenth child ends up as the keeper of the territory.
9. **A legend with a date and a place.** Local tradition dates the birth to 1735 at Leeds Point, in Atlantic County (Wikipedia: Leeds Point; Wikipedia: Atlantic County). JSTOR Daily traces the story to the almanac-maker Daniel Leeds' family and its first printed appearance in *The Atlantic* in 1859 (JSTOR Daily).
10. **Too strong to be held in the cradle.** In the version JSTOR Daily retells, the thirteenth child grows wings at midnight and flies up the chimney, and one tradition holds that it took an exorcism to banish him, for only a hundred years (JSTOR Daily). Folklore never imagined the thirteenth child as small or easily contained.
11. **Irish lore: the thirteenth child is marked.** Ireland's Schools' Collection (1937–39) records from Dromclogh, Co. Cork: "The thirteenth child of a family is always unlucky" (dúchas.ie). The belief is a warning, and it shows that people treated the thirteenth child as different from the rest.
12. **The same belief in Co. Wexford.** Pupils at Gusserane wrote that the thirteenth day of the month was unlucky and "the thirteenth child is also supposed to be unlucky" (dúchas.ie). Two counties set the thirteenth child apart in the same way: noticed, feared, never ignored.
13. **Divine, demonic or a wizard.** A study in *Studia mythologica Slavica* reports that the tenth, twelfth or thirteenth child is preserved in Slavic, Irish and Baltic folk heritage as "a deity, a demonic creature, or a wizard" (Studia mythologica Slavica). Across Europe a high-numbered child was believed to carry supernatural power.
14. **A child named 13 to beat the jinx.** In Sabah, Malaysia, a Bajau boy born thirteenth of fifteen was named Tiga Belas ("Thirteen") on a doctor's advice to break a family "jinx". He was the only child of the fifteen to survive (Los Angeles Times, 1987). Here the thirteenth child's own number was the protection.
15. **Thirteen ran his life.** The same man, known as D13, was hired on 13 January, met his wife on 13 January, was promoted on 13 September and became vice-president of the Sabah United Bajau Association on 13 September (Los Angeles Times, 1987). A thirteenth child born on the 13th, like you, would recognise the pattern.
16. **The thirteenth child as a god.** In 2010 the Iranian daily *Jomhouri Eslami* attacked the musician-mystic Peyman Fattahi in an article titled "A God who is the 13th child of his family" (Wikipedia: Peyman Fattahi). The critics reached for the thirteenth-child image because it already meant exceptional spiritual power.
17. **Jacob's thirteenth child is Benjamin, "son of the right hand". [Calculated from Genesis]** In the order Genesis gives Jacob's children (Leah's four sons, Bilhah's two, Zilpah's two, then Issachar, Zebulun, Dinah, Joseph), Benjamin is born thirteenth and last (Genesis 29:31–30:24; 35:16–18) (Genesis 30; Genesis 35). Jacob renamed him Binyamin, "son of the right hand", the hand of strength (Wikipedia: Benjamin).
18. **The thirteenth child's land held the Temple.** Tradition placed the Temple in Jerusalem partly in the territory of Benjamin, Jacob's last-born (Wikipedia: Tribe of Benjamin), and Israel's first king, Saul, came from that tribe. The thirteenth child's line held both the first crown and the holiest ground.

II. The Thirteenth Child in Literature, Opera, Film and Song

1. **An opera called *The Thirteenth Child*.** Danish composer Poul Ruders wrote *The Thirteenth Child* (2016) on the Twelve Brothers story; the Santa Fe Opera staged it in 2019 (Wikipedia; Santa Fe Opera). The heroine, Princess Lyra, is the thirteenth child whose birth decides a kingdom.
2. **Patricia Wrede's *Thirteenth Child* (2009).** Wrede's frontier-magic trilogy is narrated by Eff Rothmer, the "thirteenth child" of the title and twin of a seventh son of a seventh son (Wikipedia: Patricia Wrede). Told she is unlucky, Eff becomes the magician who holds back the wild frontier.
3. **Erin A. Craig's *The Thirteenth Child* (2024).** Hazel Trépas, "a thirteenth child, promised away to one of the gods", receives from her godfather Death the gift of knowing the exact cure for any sickness (Erin A. Craig). The book retells *Godfather Death* and puts a thirteenth child at a royal court with the king's life in her hands.
4. **Karleen Bradford, *Thirteenth Child* (1994).** The Canadian children's author published a novel under that title (Wikipedia: Karleen Bradford).
5. **Mari Ness, "The Thirteenth Child" (2015).** The fantasy writer added her own story to the tradition (Wikipedia: Mari Ness).
6. **Kristin Dimitrova, *Jacob's Thirteenth Child* (1992).** The Bulgarian poet's first collection takes its title from the thirteenth child of the patriarch (Wikipedia: Kristin Dimitrova).
7. **The film *13th Child* (2002).** Cliff Robertson co-wrote and starred in this Jersey Devil film, shot at Wharton State Forest and Batsto Village (Wikipedia; List of films set in New Jersey).
8. **The song "Thirteenth Child".** George W. Weston released "Thirteenth Child" on Glenn Records in 1960 (Wikipedia: George W. Weston), and Brandon Dalo's "Thirteenth Child" appears on the soundtrack of *Bloodlines: The Jersey Devil Curse* (WhatSong).
9. **Hollywood's Jersey Devil, again a thirteenth child.** In *Carny* (2009) the beast turns out to be "the monstrous thirteenth child of Mrs. Leeds" (Wikipedia: Carny). Writers keep returning to the thirteenth child whenever they need a figure too strong to control.
10. **Death as godfather on screen.** *American McGee's Grimm* (2008) adapted *Godfather Death* as the story of a family's thirteenth child whose godfather is Death (Wikipedia).
11. **A literary thirteenth child of the city.** Sam Savage's novel *Firmin* (2006) is narrated by a rat born the thirteenth child of a mother with twelve teats, who is left out of the feeding and turns to eating, then reading, the books of a Boston bookstore (Wikipedia: Firmin). The thirteenth had to find another source of nourishment, and it made him the most literate creature in the building.

III. Thirteenth Children Who Became Saints and Spiritual Leaders

1. **St Ignatius of Loyola**, founder of the Jesuits, was "the youngest of 13 children" (Jesuits.org; Encyclopedia.com). A thirteenth child founded the largest male religious order in the Catholic Church.

2. **Shivakumara Swami**, the "walking god" of the Siddaganga Matha, was the youngest of thirteen children. He headed the matha from 1941 and fed and educated thousands of children a day until his death at 111 (Wikipedia).
3. **St Mariam Baouardy** (Mary of Jesus Crucified), the Galilean Carmelite mystic, was her parents' thirteenth child and first daughter; none of her twelve older brothers had survived infancy (Wikipedia). She was canonised in 2015.
4. **St Pacificus of San Severino**, Franciscan friar and miracle-worker, was the youngest of thirteen children of a noble family (Wikipedia).
5. **Janet Erskine Stuart**, Superior General of the Society of the Sacred Heart and an influential Catholic educator, was the youngest of thirteen children (Wikipedia).
6. **Blessed Ángel Herrera Oria**, cardinal and founder of Catholic Action's press in Spain, was the thirteenth of fifteen children (Wikipedia).
7. **Stepan Charnetskyi**, Ukrainian poet and author of the Sich Riflemen anthem "Oi u luzi chervona kalyna", was the thirteenth child of a Greek Catholic priest's family (Wikipedia).
8. **Jelena Brajša**, "the Angel of Zagreb" and "Croatian Mother Teresa", was the youngest, thirteenth child of her family and led Zagreb's Caritas for almost forty years (Wikipedia).
9. **Archbishop Émilius Goulet** of Saint-Boniface was the youngest of thirteen children (Wikipedia).
10. **Christiane von Preysing**, first Catholic railway missionary, was the thirteenth and youngest child of Count Arco-Zinneberg (Wikipedia).
11. **Renjun, thirteenth child of Rennyo**, the Jōdo Shinshū patriarch, founded the temple Ganshō-ji in Ise around 1500, the origin of today's Nagoya Betsuin (Wikipedia).
12. **Don Miguel Ruiz**, author of *The Four Agreements*, was the youngest of thirteen children (Wikipedia).

IV. Thirteenth Children Who Ruled

1. **Maria Carolina of Austria**, thirteenth child of Empress Maria Theresa, became Queen of Naples and Sicily and the de facto ruler of her husband's kingdoms (Wikipedia). The thirteenth child held the real power on the throne.
2. **Archduke John of Austria**, thirteenth child of Emperor Leopold II, was elected Imperial Regent (Reichsverweser) of Germany in 1848 (Wikipedia). A nation's first parliament chose a thirteenth child as its head of state.
3. **Prince Henry of Prussia**, thirteenth child of King Frederick William I, never lost a battle in the Seven Years' War and in 1786 was proposed as a possible monarch for the United States (Wikipedia).
4. **Leopold of Brunswick**, the thirteenth child and youngest son of Duke Charles I, died in 1785 trying to rescue townspeople from the flooded Oder, and became famous across Europe for it (Wikipedia).
5. **Louis Günther of Nassau**, thirteenth and youngest child of John VI of Nassau, was a lieutenant general of cavalry in the Eighty Years' War (Wikipedia).
6. **Louis Günther II**, Prince of Schwarzburg-Rudolstadt, grew up as the thirteenth and youngest child and later ruled the principality (Wikipedia).
7. **Philip, Duke of Schleswig-Holstein-Sonderburg-Glücksburg**, was the thirteenth child and seventh son of Duke John the Younger, and founded the ducal line of Glücksburg (Wikipedia).
8. **Princess Anne Charlotte of Lorraine**, thirteenth of fourteen children of Duke Leopold, ruled as Princess-Abbess of Remiremont and Mons (Wikipedia).

9. **Prince Luigi, Count of Aquila**, thirteenth child of King Francis I of the Two Sicilies, commanded the Neapolitan navy (Wikipedia).
10. **Frederick Francis of Brunswick-Wolfenbüttel**, youngest of the thirteen children of Duke Ferdinand Albert II, was a Prussian officer under Frederick the Great (Wikipedia).
11. **Emily Donelson**, the thirteenth child of John Donelson, served as White House hostess for her uncle by marriage, President Andrew Jackson (Wikipedia). A thirteenth child presided over the President's house.
12. **Dorothy Townshend, Viscountess Townshend**, thirteenth child of Robert Walpole senior, was the sister of Britain's first Prime Minister and wife of the Secretary of State Lord Townshend (Wikipedia).

V. Thirteenth Children Who Led Nations and Armies

1. **Abiy Ahmed**, Prime Minister of Ethiopia and 2019 Nobel Peace laureate, is "the 13th child of his father" (Wikipedia).
2. **Sir Roy Welensky**, the thirteenth child of his parents, became Prime Minister of the Federation of Rhodesia and Nyasaland (Wikipedia).
3. **Sir Albert Dunstan**, the thirteenth child of his family, was Premier of Victoria from 1935 to 1945, the second-longest premiership in the state's history (Wikipedia).
4. **Marshal Andrei Grechko**, "the thirteenth child born to a family of Ukrainian peasants", became Soviet Minister of Defence (1967–76) (Wikipedia).
5. **Robert C. Winthrop**, youngest of thirteen children, was Speaker of the US House of Representatives (Wikipedia).
6. **James Madison Porter**, youngest of thirteen children, was the 18th US Secretary of War and a founder of Lafayette College (Wikipedia).
7. **Marshal Thomas Robert Bugeaud**, youngest of thirteen children, became a Marshal of France and Governor-General of Algeria (Wikipedia).
8. **Jacques Pierre Brissot**, the thirteenth child of a Chartres caterer, led the Girondins in the French Revolution (Wikipedia).
9. **Václav Kopecký**, the thirteenth child of a small tradesman, became one of the most powerful ministers of post-war Czechoslovakia (Wikipedia).
10. **Charles-Ferdinand Nothomb**, thirteenth and youngest child of Pierre Nothomb, became Belgium's Foreign Minister and President of the Chamber (Wikipedia).
11. **Alexander Randall**, the thirteenth child of his parents, was Attorney General of Maryland (1864–68) (Wikipedia).
12. **General Henry Tureman Allen**, thirteenth of fourteen children, explored Alaska's Copper River and commanded the US occupation forces in Germany after the First World War (Wikipedia).
13. **Admiral Sir Assheton Curzon-Howe**, thirteenth and youngest child of the 1st Earl Howe, commanded the Mediterranean Fleet (1908–10) (Wikipedia).
14. **Sir Peter Scratchley**, the thirteenth child of his father, was a military engineer, defence adviser to the Australian colonies and Special Commissioner for New Guinea (Wikipedia).
15. **Mikhail Devyataev**, the thirteenth child of a Moksha peasant family, escaped a Nazi camp on Usedom by hijacking a German bomber with nine other prisoners, and was made a Hero of the Soviet Union (Wikipedia).
16. **Harry Daniels VC**, the thirteenth child of a Norfolk baker, won the Victoria Cross at Neuve Chapelle in 1915 (Wikipedia).

17. **Augustus Agar VC**, the thirteenth child of his father, won the Victoria Cross in 1919 for sinking a Bolshevik cruiser from a small motor boat (Wikipedia).
18. **Allen Allensworth**, youngest of thirteen children and born into slavery, escaped to the Union army, became an Army chaplain and lieutenant colonel, and founded the town of Allensworth, California (Wikipedia).
19. **Anita Hill**, the youngest of thirteen siblings, became a law professor whose 1991 testimony changed how the United States talks about workplace harassment (PBS / THIRTEEN, Finding Your Roots).

VI. Thirteenth Children Who Healed, Built and Created

1. **Hattie McDaniel**, the youngest of thirteen children, was the first Black person to win an Academy Award (1940) (Wikipedia; BOTWC).
2. **Agnes Baden-Powell**, thirteenth of fourteen children, co-founded the Girl Guides and wrote its first handbook (Wikipedia).
3. **Thomas Barnardo**, born the thirteenth child, founded the Barnardo's homes, which had taken in nearly 60,000 children by his death (Wikipedia: J. M. Barnardo & Son; Wikipedia: Barnardo).
4. **Per Teodor Cleve**, the thirteenth child of his father, discovered the chemical elements holmium and thulium (Wikipedia).
5. **Luther Burbank**, thirteenth of fifteen children, developed more than 800 plant varieties, including the Russet Burbank potato (Wikipedia).
6. **Dr Clemence Lozier**, youngest of thirteen children, founded the New York Medical College and Hospital for Women and led the National Woman Suffrage Association (Wikipedia).
7. **Eartha M. M. White**, the thirteenth child of a formerly enslaved mother, became a Jacksonville humanitarian, philanthropist and businesswoman who established Mercy Hospital and the city's first public park for African Americans (Wikipedia).
8. **Dmitry Golubev**, the thirteenth child of an Orthodox archpriest, became a surgeon and Hero of Socialist Labour (Wikipedia).
9. **James Strachey**, youngest of thirteen children, translated the *Standard Edition* of Freud's works into English (Modernist Archives).
10. **César Ritz**, youngest of thirteen children, founded the Ritz hotels, the name that became a synonym for luxury (Wikipedia).
11. **Premasiri Khemadasa**, "no ordinary thirteenth child", was a self-taught Sri Lankan composer who wrote operas, symphonies and the scores of more than 150 films (Khemadasa biography; Wikipedia).
12. **Leigh Harline**, youngest of thirteen children, wrote the music for "When You Wish Upon a Star" and won two Academy Awards for *Pinocchio* (Wikipedia).
13. **Ricardo Sánchez**, youngest of thirteen children, became a poet and a founding voice of the Chicano Movement (EBSCO).
14. **Felix Timmermans**, thirteenth of fourteen children, became one of Flanders' best-loved novelists (Wikipedia).
15. **Serge Poliakoff**, thirteenth of fourteen children, became a celebrated abstract painter in Paris (Wikipedia).
16. **Harriet Bosse**, thirteenth of fourteen children, was a leading Scandinavian actress (Wikipedia).
17. **Jaan Koort**, the thirteenth child of village farmers, became one of Estonia's founding modern sculptors (Wikipedia), as did **Ants Laikmaa**, the thirteenth child of a poor Estonian family, in painting (Wikipedia).

18. **Horacio Guarany**, the thirteenth child of a Guaraní father, became one of Argentina's great folk singers (Wikipedia).
19. **S. N. Lakshmi**, born the thirteenth child, acted in hundreds of Tamil films and thousands of stage dramas (Wikipedia).
20. **Paul Prudhomme**, youngest of thirteen children, made Cajun cooking famous worldwide (Wikipedia).
21. **Romain Maes**, "the 13th child in his family", won the 1935 Tour de France, wearing the yellow jersey from the first stage to the last (Wikipedia).
22. **Jim Londos**, "the Golden Greek" and youngest of thirteen children, was one of the biggest wrestling stars of the 1920s–40s and the first immigrant athletic superstar in the United States (Wikipedia).
23. **Frank McGuire**, youngest of thirteen children, coached North Carolina to the 1957 national championship and is in the Basketball Hall of Fame (Wikipedia).
24. **Curley Culp**, youngest of thirteen children, became a Pro Football Hall of Fame defensive tackle (Wikipedia).

VII. The Thirteenth Child in Your Chart

1. **The thirteenth house is the first. [Calculated, ch. 1]** Counting thirteen houses from your Aquarius lagna brings you back to the lagna itself, where Jupiter rises. In this book's reading the thirteenth child's place in the chart is the seat of the self, occupied by the planet of wisdom and the guru.
2. **The youngest-sibling house holds your chart ruler. [Calculated, ch. 1]** Jyotish reads younger siblings and one's own courage from the 3rd house. Yours holds Saturn, the lagna lord, and classical texts say a malefic there makes the native bold and self-made (Phaladeepika 8, BPHS 12, as cited in ch. 1). The last-born's house is where your own ruling planet lives.
3. **The elder-siblings house is your strongest. [Calculated, ch. 1]** The 11th house, of elder siblings, gains and networks, has your highest sarvashtakavarga score (37) and the highest bhava bala (497). For a thirteenth child, twelve older siblings in your strongest house is a support system, and the same house is where the chart puts your income.
4. **The chain of the 3rd ends in the 13th nakshatra. [Calculated, ch. 1]** The 3rd lord's dispositor chain, Mars to Sun to Mercury and Venus, ends in Hasta, the thirteenth nakshatra. Hasta means "hand": skill and making things with your own hands. The house of the youngest child resolves into the thirteenth lunar mansion.